MODULE 12 · DOMAIN 1 - PEOPLE

# Shared vision and stakeholder analysis

Building a vision everyone can repeat, finding every stakeholder, and working out who needs what kind of attention.

DOMAIN I - People  EXAM WEIGHT 33%  MODULE 12 of 49

admin@sthithapragna.com

A vision nobody can repeat in their own words is **not shared**.

# What a common vision does

- Gives every decision a **filter**: does this move us towards the vision?
- **Aligns** teams, stakeholders and suppliers who never meet each other.
- Lets empowered teams decide well without asking permission each time.
- The outline asks you to **ensure it is shared, promote it, and keep it current**.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Empowerment without a shared vision produces confident teams heading in different directions.

# Tools for creating a shared vision

| TOOL | HOW IT WORKS |
| --- | --- |
| Vision statement | One or two sentences on who it is for, what it does, and why it matters |
| Elevator statement | For [who], who [need], our [product] is [what], that [benefit], unlike [alternative] |
| Product box | The team designs the box it would sell in: name, three benefits, one picture |
| Vision board or canvas | One page: target group, needs, product, business goals |
| Project canvas | A one-page view of purpose, objectives, stakeholders and constraints |

ON THE EXAM

Create the vision together, with key stakeholders. A vision handed down is understood, not shared.

# Promoting the vision and keeping it current

- **Repeat it**: at kickoff, in planning, at every review, when onboarding people.
- Make it **visible**: on the team board, at the top of the backlog, in status reports.
- **Revisit it** when the market, regulation or organisation changes. M.O.R.E. calls this relentlessly reassessing.
- A vision that no longer matches reality is worse than none: it confidently points the wrong way.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> When the world changes, update the vision with stakeholders, then tell everyone what changed and why.

# Spotting a misunderstood vision

- Teams deliver work that **conflicts**, each sure they followed the vision.
- Stakeholders are **surprised** at reviews by what was built.
- Priorities keep **changing direction** as different people interpret the goal.
- Test it: ask people to restate the vision, then break down exactly where their versions differ.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The outline's enabler: break down the situation to identify the root cause of the misunderstanding.

# Identifying stakeholders

- Start **early**, as soon as the project is authorised, and keep going **throughout**.
- Sources: the charter, the business case, organisation charts, contracts, past projects' lessons learned.
- Techniques: interviews, brainstorming, asking each stakeholder 'who else should we talk to?'
- A stakeholder you miss does not disappear. They appear later, usually objecting.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Identification is continuous. New stakeholders appear as the project reaches new people and places.

# The stakeholder register

| PART | TYPICAL CONTENTS |
| --- | --- |
| Identification | Name, role, organisation, contact details, location |
| Assessment | Requirements, expectations, interests, influence, attitude |
| Classification | Internal or external; category; position on analysis grids |
| Engagement | Current and desired engagement; preferred communication |

ON THE EXAM

The register is a living document. It is updated whenever a stakeholder, or their position, changes.

# Handle the register with care

- Assessment notes can be **sensitive**: 'resists the project', 'low interest', 'influences the board'.
- Share the parts people need, such as names, roles and contact details, widely.
- Keep **sensitive assessments restricted** to those who need them.
- A stakeholder who reads a blunt assessment of themselves becomes a harder stakeholder.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Transparency is a value, but so is discretion. Share the register in layers.

# The power and interest grid

| QUADRANT | STRATEGY | IN PRACTICE |
|---|---|---|
| High power, high interest | Manage closely | Involve in decisions; regular, rich engagement |
| High power, low interest | Keep satisfied | Brief, relevant updates; consult on what affects them |
| Low power, high interest | Keep informed | Regular information; listen to their concerns |
| Low power, low interest | Monitor | Light touch; watch for changes in position |

ON THE EXAM

The trap is the high-power, low-interest group: bury them in detail and they disengage or turn hostile.

# Other analysis models

| MODEL | WHAT IT ADDS |
| --- | --- |
| Power/influence, impact/influence | Grid variations with other axes |
| Salience model | Power, legitimacy, urgency: who first |
| Directions of influence | Upward, downward, outward, sideways |
| Stakeholder cube | Three attributes in one view |
| Personas | Fictional profiles of user groups |

ON THE EXAM

The model matters less than the habit: analyse before you engage.

# The salience model

- **Power**: can they impose their will on the project?
- **Legitimacy**: is their involvement appropriate and recognised?
- **Urgency**: do they need attention now, and is their claim time-sensitive?
- Stakeholders with **all three** are definitive: they need attention first.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> A regulator with an urgent, legitimate demand outranks a louder stakeholder with only one attribute.

# Engagement assessment: Project Lantern

| STAKEHOLDER | UNAWARE | RESISTANT | NEUTRAL | SUPPORTIVE | LEADING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Clinic managers | | C | | D | |
| Reception staff union rep | C | | D | | |
| Head of patient access | | | | C | D |
| Health data regulator | | | C, D | | |

ON THE EXAM

C is where they are now. D is where you need them. The gap drives the engagement plan.

# Closing the engagement gap

- **Unaware**: inform them. They cannot support what they do not know about.
- **Resistant**: understand why, privately. Resistance usually protects a real interest.
- **Neutral**: show how the project serves their goals.
- Not everyone needs to lead. Aim for the engagement the project actually needs from each person.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Resistance is information. Find the interest it protects before trying to change it.

# Categorising stakeholders

- The outline asks you to **categorise stakeholders**, as the first step in aligning expectations.
- By relationship: internal or external; customer, supplier, regulator, sponsor, user.
- By stance: supporters, neutrals, resistors.
- By need: what they require from the project, and what they fear from it.
- Categories let you tailor communication and engagement per group, not one message for all.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> One message for every stakeholder satisfies none of them. Categorise, then tailor.

# Personas: stakeholders on agile projects

- A **persona** is a realistic, fictional profile of a type of user: goals, frustrations, context.
- Built from research with real users, not invented at a desk.
- Keeps the team designing for real needs when users cannot be in every conversation.
- Lantern: 'Maria, 78, books by phone, struggles with small screens, needs large text'.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Personas complement real user contact. They never replace it.

# Scenario signals and the move

| THE SCENARIO SAYS | THE MOVE |
|---|---|
| People give different answers about the goal | Create the vision together with key stakeholders |
| Project just authorised | Identify stakeholders from charter, business case, interviews |
| Powerful executive, little interest | Keep satisfied: brief, relevant updates |
| Key stakeholder is resistant | Understand their concerns privately; plan engagement |
| Sensitive notes on a shared register | Restrict assessments; share the rest |
| The market has changed the goal | Revisit and update the vision, then communicate it |

ON THE EXAM

Vision first, then find everyone, analyse them, and tailor your engagement to each.

> Two weeks into a new project, the project manager asks five team members and two key stakeholders what the project is for.
>
> The seven answers range from 'cutting costs' to 'improving customer experience' to 'replacing an old system'.

## What should the project manager do?

A Send everyone the approved business case to read.

B Start delivery and let a shared understanding develop over time.

C Facilitate a workshop with key stakeholders and the team to create a shared vision.

D Ask the sponsor to write and circulate a vision statement.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

## What should the project manager do?

A Send the business case.

*Information is not alignment. People read the same document differently.*

B Let it develop.

*Divergent understanding produces conflicting work, not convergence.*

C Workshop to create the vision together.

Builds a vision people can repeat, because they helped shape it.

D Sponsor writes it.

*A vision handed down is understood at best, not shared.*

THE SIGNAL

Seven people, several different purposes: the vision is not shared. Create it together.

> A project manager has just received a signed project charter for a new warehouse management system.
>
> The charter names the sponsor and three departments. No other stakeholder work has been done.

## What should the project manager do next?

A Identify stakeholders using the charter, business case, organisation charts and interviews, and record them in a register.

B Write the communications management plan for the three departments named.

C Send a kickoff meeting invitation to the three department heads.

D Wait until requirements are gathered to see who else is involved.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

## What should the project manager do next?

**A** Identify stakeholders broadly; start the register.
The first step after authorisation. Everything else depends on it.

**B** Communications plan for three departments.
*Plans communication before knowing who needs it.*

**C** Invite three heads to kickoff.
*Assumes the charter's list is complete. Warehouse staff, IT and suppliers are missing.*

**D** Wait for requirements.
*Requirements come from stakeholders. Waiting reverses the order.*

THE SIGNAL

Just authorised: identify stakeholders first, widely. The charter's list is a starting point, not the list.

> The chief financial officer can stop the project's funding, but shows little interest in its day-to-day progress.
>
> She has complained that the weekly twenty-page status reports she receives waste her time.

**How should the project manager engage her?**

A Keep sending the full weekly reports so she has complete information.

B Keep her satisfied: short, relevant updates, and consult her on decisions that affect funding.

C Remove her from all distribution lists and monitor her only.

D Invite her to the team's daily coordination meeting.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

## How should the project manager engage her?

A Keep the full reports.

*Ignores her feedback and the exact trap of the high-power, low-interest group.*

B Keep satisfied: short, relevant, consult on funding.

High power, low interest: the grid's strategy, fitted to what she cares about.

C Monitor only.

*Treats a stakeholder who can stop funding as if she had no power.*

D Daily meetings.

*Even more detail, for someone who wants less.*

THE SIGNAL

High power, low interest: keep satisfied. Brief, relevant, and consulted on what matters to them.

> The engagement assessment matrix shows the head of operations as resistant. The project needs her to be supportive before the roll-out begins.
>
> She has attended meetings but raised few specific objections.

## What should the project manager do next?

A Ask the sponsor to instruct her to support the project.

B Stop inviting her to meetings until she is more positive.

C Send her more frequent and detailed progress reports.

D Meet her privately to understand her concerns, then plan actions to address them.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

# What should the project manager do next?

A Sponsor instructs her.

*Compliance, not support. The real concern stays hidden and resurfaces at roll-out.*

B Exclude her.

*Turns quiet resistance into open opposition.*

C More reports.

*Information does not address a concern nobody has identified.*

D Meet privately; understand; plan actions.

Resistance usually protects an interest. Find it, then address it.

THE SIGNAL

Resistant, with no stated objection: the concern is hidden. Find it privately before trying to change it.

> The stakeholder register is on a shared drive that the whole project can read. It includes the project manager's notes that a vice president 'opposes the project and influences the board'.
>
> A team member asks for the full register to plan a presentation to that vice president's department.

## What should the project manager do?

A Share the full register, since project information should be transparent.

B Restrict the sensitive assessment notes, and share the information the team member needs.

C Delete all assessment notes from the register.

D Refuse all access to the register.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

## What should the project manager do?

A Share it all.

*Sensitive judgements about a senior person, on an open drive, risk serious harm.*

B Restrict sensitive notes; share what is needed.

Balances transparency with discretion, and fixes the open-drive exposure.

C Delete the notes.

*Loses analysis the project needs to engage the stakeholder well.*

D Refuse all access.

*Blocks legitimate work. Most of the register is not sensitive.*

THE SIGNAL

**Share the register in layers. Assessments of individuals stay restricted.**

> A product vision promised 'the only app that lets customers compare every local energy tariff'. A large competitor has just launched exactly that, for free.
>
> The team is carrying on with its existing priorities, and the product owner is unsure what to change.

## What should the project manager do?

A Continue with the existing priorities, since the vision was approved.

B Let the development team decide a new direction among themselves.

C Wait for the next quarterly review before changing anything.

D Work with the product owner and key stakeholders to revisit the vision, then communicate the update.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

## What should the project manager do?

A Continue; it was approved.

*Follows a vision that no longer matches reality. Work loses value daily.*

B Team decides the direction.

*Product direction belongs with the product owner and stakeholders.*

C Wait for the quarterly review.

*Keeps building towards an obsolete goal for weeks.*

D Revisit the vision together; communicate it.

Keeps the vision current, with the right people, then aligns everyone.

THE SIGNAL

The world changed the vision's premise. Revisit it now, with the right people, and tell everyone.

A vision people can repeat. Every stakeholder found. **Attention matched to each.**